



The US: welcoming or exclusionary?

English 12, 13

4 New restrictions at the start of WW I + labor shortages during WW II



Salad bowl or melting pot?

After World War I, the United States experienced a surge in immigration from Eastern and Southern Europe, as well as Asia. This influx fueled **nativist sentiments, as many Americans sought to preserve what they perceived as traditional American values and culture (from Northern Europe).**

There was a growing fear of radical foreign ideologies—such as communism and anarchism—being introduced by immigrants, particularly those from regions with vastly different political systems. Additionally, economic anxieties about job competition from immigrant labor contributed to widespread anti-immigrant attitudes.



[Immigration Act of 1924](#)

- 15) What was the Immigration Act of 1924 about and what kind of general quota was introduced?



President Kennedy

President Kennedy supported efforts to reform those laws, however, he had only little support in Congress and was assassinated in 1963. Kennedy himself did not sign a new immigration act, but his administration and family played a pivotal role in the movement that led to the 1965 reform, which finally ended the quota system.

- 16) What reform was signed into law by President Lyndon B. Johnson?





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President Lyndon B. Johnson

President LBJ replaced the Immigration Act of 1924 with a new system that prioritized family reunification and skilled labor, opening the door to more immigration from non-European countries —> back to the salad bowl

Mexicans Fill Labor Shortages During WWII

17 What did businesses in the US use the Bracero Program for?



[The Bracero Program of 1942](#)

18 What work did the braceros do and what did they get in return?



bracero =
farm hand

19 What abuses did the braceros suffer from?

20 What happened in 1964 and what was the situation like after the program had ended?

